

# Post-incident review PIR-2025-007

## Notification Service: degraded latency

*Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.*

### Summary

On 06 January 2025, Notification Service experienced degraded latency in production (US West) for about 40 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that the autoscaler reached its maximum instance count during a traffic peak.

### Impact

Users of Notification Service saw degraded latency for about 40 minutes. The service owner, Messaging, led the response.

### Timeline

- 09:06 First signal received.
- 09:29 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:59 Likely cause identified.
- 10:14 Mitigation applied.
- 10:40 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

### What happened

Investigation found that the autoscaler reached its maximum instance count during a traffic peak.

No dependency outages were reported by upstream providers during the window.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

### What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

### Actions

- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.